

news feed

DIGIT AUGUST 2003

hypothesis

Ultra Wideband (UWB)

■ What is it?

It is a wireless technology that transmits data using an extremely short duration burst of radio frequency (RF) energy. Unlike other wireless standards UWB does not use a carrier wave to transmit data. It is faster than Bluetooth and consumes less power. It is being extensively used for military applications.

■ Why UWB?

It can be used to set up Personal Area Networks (PANs). UWB pulses can be used in multi-user network applications, as the UWB pulses have a short time duration. It has a very high bandwidth of 100 Mbps. Also UWB chipsets would be cheaper than other wireless chipsets.

■ How do I use it?

Currently there aren't many UWB-based products in the market. But many companies have started releasing UWB chipsets. UWB-based entertainment devices will allow seamless transfer of media files between them at very high speeds.

snapshot

16 million camera phones will be sold worldwide in **2002**, growing strongly to **147 million** in **2007**

Source: Strategy Analytics

Intel sees chip industry plateau

Chip giant Intel says industry growth will slow down but remain in double-digits.

Chief Executive Craig Barrett said, "I do believe that growth rates will perhaps decline a bit. Maybe they will come down a few percentage points, but they will probably remain double-digit".

Intel saw its net income more than double in the second quarter of 2003. The company announced profits of \$896 million compared to \$446 million in 2002. Much of the increased profit compared to the 2002 figures were due to last year's write downs of areas such as online services, totaling \$218 million. Intel says revenues for its key product areas

in microprocessors and chipsets were essentially flat for the quarter as average prices and volumes remained stable from the previous quarter.

Intel is now to spend more on R&D in 2003 than it originally planned. The move to 65-nm processes from 90-nm is now expected to be around \$4.2 billion compared to \$4.0 billion. However, overall the company is remaining cautious over the global economy and says third quarter revenues will be between \$6.9 billion and \$7.5 billion. The company is pointing to the new generation of Pentium processors, Centrino systems and the emerging 65-nm processes to drive revenues forward in the future.



Mobile throwing competition

People have heard of and participated in all sorts of competitions. But this one combines the traditional test of strength with a taste of technology. Eastern Europeans conduct annual competitions for throwing mobile phones, yes you read it right. The current record is 66 metres, with a Nokia 5110. A company called Fenolingua, provides the

mobile phones, and sponsors the competition. The fourth such competition will be held on 23rd of August, 2003 in Savonlinna, Finland. In case you want to show off your skills you can register yourself at the site www.fenolingua.fi/mobile.htm. Prizes are awarded based on style, aesthetics and the length of the throw.



ILLUSTRATIONS: Mahesh Benkar

SuSE in space

Linux developer SuSE secured a 2.4 million euro deal with the German Aerospace Center (DLR). SuSE Linux will provide the software infrastructure for the Columbus module that will be launched to the International Space Station in October 2004. The Columbus control centre provided by DLR will include monitoring and control of Columbus' on-board systems, the coordination of the European payload operation and the provision of the communication network for operations and data distribution. SuSE provides the software infrastructure for the module's data needs. Columbus will continue to send data back to earth for the next 15 years. To handle all this data there are 46 IBM Dual-Xeon servers, two Sun Solaris systems, almost 25 Terabytes of EMC CLARiiON CX600 storage, ADIC StorNext HSM, Legato Networker Backup as well as an ADIC Scalar10k tape library with more than 70 Terabytes of storage for backup and archiving. All this will be running on SuSE's Linux Enterprise Server 8.



missed your last chance to buy shares of Manuti?

*Don't miss the last chance! See page 102-103



■ White House mail services were struck by a distributed denial of service attack (DDOS) ■ Slackware—a volunteer distribution of Linux, turns 10